

Section C (30 marks)

Students will be required to write 200-220 words in the form of a letter, report or article in French based on a short printed French-language stimulus. Students must respond to four-six linked bullet points and demonstrate their ability to communicate accurately in French using correct grammar and syntax as detailed in *Appendix 6: Grammar lists*.

Students will have individual control over the pace of this examination, including the listening element. However, for practical reasons, they must start the listening section first and must complete this within the first 45 minutes.

A CD recording will be provided for each student with the examination paper. Student access to equipment that permits individual listening (eg portable CD player with headphones) is required.

All students for this unit will be assessed by Edexcel.

Students must not have access to a dictionary or other reference materials during this examination.

Preparation

Students can prepare for the assessments in this unit by regularly consulting a wide variety of French-language reading and listening materials (textbooks, magazines, the internet, podcasts etc). As part of their AS studies, students should undertake regular listening, reading and writing activities.

Time allocation

Students will have individual control over the pace of assessment in this unit. They **must** undertake the listening element of this unit within the first 45 minutes of the examination but may then answer the remaining questions in any order of their choice.

The duration of this examination will be 2 hours and 30 minutes.

2.3 Content

Focus

This unit will feature questions drawn from a variety of sources but which all relate to the general topic areas below. However, these should be considered as different contexts in which students can write and understand the French language. *Detailed, specialist* French vocabulary or *detailed and specialist* knowledge of the chosen general topic area are **not** required.

Similarly, knowledge of the chosen general topic area in relation to France and other parts of the French-speaking world will **not** be assessed.

General topic areas

- Youth culture and concerns
- Lifestyle: health and fitness
- The world around us: travel, tourism, environmental issues and the French-speaking world
- Education and employment

Linked subtopics

To inform teaching and learning, the following definitive list of linked subtopics has been produced for this unit.

Youth culture and concerns

- Music and fashion
- Technology (eg MP3/blogs/mobile phones/internet/games)
- Relationships (family/friendships and peer pressure)
- Drink, drugs, sex

Lifestyle: health and fitness

- Sport and exercise
- Food and diet
- Health issues (eg smoking, skin cancer, health services)

The world around us: travel, tourism, environmental issues and the French-speaking world

- Tourist information, travel and transport
- Weather (eg natural disasters, climate change)
- Pollution and recycling

Education and employment

- Education (schooling and higher education)
- Education policy and student issues
- The world of work (eg the changing work scene, job opportunities and unemployment)

Listening element

Recordings will relate to French-speaking countries or communities and exploit contemporary sources. These may include telephone messages, announcements, advertisements, interviews, radio talks, reviews, conversations, discussions, broadcasts and the internet. The listening material will not total more than 450-600 words and the recording will have a duration of approximately five minutes.

Reading element

Printed materials may relate to both the contemporary society and cultural heritage of French-speaking countries or communities. Sources used will be contemporary, such as magazines, newspapers, the internet, reports and books. It is anticipated that the printed materials will total 550-700 words.

What students need to learn

Students need to develop language skills that enable them to communicate effectively, accurately and confidently in French-language writing, to transfer meaning from French into English, and to understand spoken and written French.

Students will be expected to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the grammar and structures as prescribed in *Appendix 6: Grammar lists*.

Students will be assessed for the following.

Section A (20 marks)

Listening — AO1 via assessment-specific mark scheme.

Section B (20 marks)

Reading and transfer of meaning — AO2 via assessment-specific mark scheme.

Section C (30 marks)

A maximum of 30 marks will be awarded positively using the assessment criteria grids in Section 2.4 for the written response to a stimulus exercise.

The assessment criteria reward students for:

- **content and response** — AO2 (15 marks)
- **quality of language** — AO3 (15 marks).